

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Artie Ficial

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theater.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Your other secret

You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Monet Bags has seen the governance addendum.
- Quietly learn whether Claire O'Scuro would stay if you left.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*
- 2 *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*
- 3 *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighborhood of a secret.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant attached my resignation to his gift. I had accepted a job at another museum and had not told the board. He planned to present my departure as their price for keeping the collection. I wanted the chair to hear the terms before he announced them.

IF MURDERER

Grant attached my resignation to his gift. I had accepted a job at another museum and had not told the board. He planned to present my departure as their price for keeping the collection. I wanted that announcement stopped.



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Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I forged a signed letter from Grant demanding my resignation, then sent it to the chair. Grant had made it a condition of his gift; I wanted the board forced to debate the demand before accepting his unsigned gift agreement. I spent the welcome reception trying to reach the chair, then took her call in my office. The speech folder was on my desk. I had not agreed to the resignation, whatever his signature on my forged letter appeared to say.

IF MURDERER

I forged a signed letter from Grant demanding my resignation, then sent it to the chair. Grant had made it a condition of his gift; I wanted the board forced to debate the demand before accepting his unsigned gift agreement. I spent the welcome reception trying to reach the chair, then took her call in my office. The speech folder was on my desk. I had not agreed to the resignation, whatever his signature on my forged letter appeared to say.



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Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The chair called while I was in my office. She wanted the resignation read to the board before the announcement; I kept the call running until we heard the toast through the gallery doors. The signed demand in my folder is a forgery I made to force that discussion. The chair's call log and my marked draft record what we were arguing about. I intended to leave Grant with a board dispute he could not announce away.

IF MURDERER

The signature on that resignation demand is the one I copied. Grant never signed it. I put the demand in his speech folder so that he would have to answer it before the board. I had not agreed to resign on his terms. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my resignation envelope. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved Grant's glass to put the acknowledgment cards where he would read them.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Artie Ficial

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I forged Grant's signed resignation demand and sent it to the chair. I wanted the board forced to discuss his conditions instead of leaving them inside an unsigned gift agreement. The chair's call log and my draft show what we argued over. I did not kill him. I will disclose the forgery and the job I accepted elsewhere. The board can decide which departure it now prefers.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my resignation envelope when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. I was leaving the museum, but I could not bear to let him own it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Claire O'Scuro

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Claire O'Scuro

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Your other secret

Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Dr. Art E. Fact has seen the same gap you found.
- Learn who wrote the anonymous warning note.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



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- 1 *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*
- 2 *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*
- 3 *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*



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Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I concealed the independent review from the board. The Star Bowl label now presents a disputed history as settled ownership. That label goes out under my department's name. Grant supplied the money and expected that to make him the curator. I had spent months building this exhibition; I was angry enough to change its wording without permission.

IF MURDERER

I concealed the independent review from the board. The Star Bowl label now presents a disputed history as settled ownership. That label goes out under my department's name. Grant supplied the money and expected that to make him the curator. He was turning the exhibition I had built into evidence for his own claim.



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Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed the exhibition label while the reception was underway. I removed the claim that the Star Bowl's ownership was settled and added the independent review's objection. Grant caught me with the old label in my hand. I told him he could complain to the board with the same incomplete file he had supplied me. He reached for the replacement label. I kept it and the old one.

IF MURDERER

I changed the exhibition label while the reception was underway. I removed the claim that the Star Bowl's ownership was settled and added the independent review's objection. Grant caught me with the old label in my hand. I told him he could complain to the board with the same incomplete file he had supplied me. He reached for the replacement label. I kept it and the old one.



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Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

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Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The removed label and the independent review record the same missing permit. The registrar photographed the replacement before Grant objected. My red stain was label ink. The inventory's red proof slip is plain paper, without metallic backing. I had concealed the review, but I did not invent its ownership objection. The signed findings and the retained old label can both be examined.

IF MURDERER

The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my label folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I shifted the glass to lay the provenance proof flat.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Claire O'Scuro

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed the independent review and changed the display label without approval. The missing permit is real; the registrar kept both versions of the label. I did not poison Grant. The board will receive the review I withheld. If it removes me from the exhibition, the ownership question will still have to be answered.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my label folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. I wanted the review published. I killed the man trying to suppress it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Hugh Bidder

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

- Buys art for **Elon Mosaic**. **Elon** likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.
- **Penny Pincher** asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.
- Keeps offering to represent **Vincent Van Faux**. **Vincent** wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Hugh Bidder. Everything has a price. My charming conversation is the only exception, and even that is negotiable.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Hugh Bidder

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Your other secret

You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Saul D. Bid knows about the disputed certificate.
- Keep Elon Mosaic from discussing the 'auction incident' in public.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



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The game is afoot

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- 1 *A seat with a cold metallic skeleton keeps its secret underneath.*
- 2 *A little door hides shelves and, tonight, a secret.*
- 3 *A book beginning with creation has a secret between its pages.*



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Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

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What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The certificate was forged before it reached me. I then altered my file to hide how badly I had been fooled. Grant intended to call that a forgery of my own unless I refunded millions. My professional judgment was poor. His price for keeping quiet was excellent, for him.

IF MURDERER

I altered my file after discovering the certificate was false. Grant wanted millions back and a public admission that I had created the forgery. He knew that wasn't true. He preferred an expensive villain to a complicated transaction, especially when he could make the villain pay twice.



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ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Hugh Bidder

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

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What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.

IF MURDERER

I took the reserve-price call outside before entering. The broker wanted to know why the certificate in my file no longer matched the one sent to the buyer. I said it was a clerical correction. It was concealment. When I finally spoke to Grant, I offered a settlement. He wanted a refund on a scale that would close the firm. He kept the offer; I retained the envelope.



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Hugh Bidder

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Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

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What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

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What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

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Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

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Hugh Bidder

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I first entered at 6:29, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt records that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it.

IF MURDERER

I first entered at 6:17, delayed by a dispute over a reserve price. My entrance receipt documents that first admission, not a second visit. The certificate in the sale file was false, and my alteration concealed that failure rather than curing it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my settlement envelope. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass out of the way of the offer.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Hugh Bidder

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Hugh Bidder

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The certificate was already false when I received it. Altering my file afterward was my decision. I entered at 6:29, after the bottle had been locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will give the buyer the unaltered correspondence and negotiate the refund without pretending a changed file repairs the sale.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my settlement envelope when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He could expose the false certificate and destroy my business. I chose murder over admitting it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Monet Bags

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Monet Bags

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Sue Venir** on museum budgets and donor agreements.
- Checks **Brie DeVivre**'s catering bills. **Brie** needs to explain every extra charge.
- **Elon Mosaic** keeps suggesting new museum technology. Monet keeps asking who will pay for it.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see. You're not afraid to spend money as long as it's a wise investment.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Monet Bags. I'm the CFO and I oversee the numbers. Please enjoy the gala, but know that any additional expenditures will not be reimbursed without a receipt.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Your other secret

You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Sue Venir has seen Grant's draft funding agreement.
- Keep Artie Ficial from learning about the temporary transfer unless absolutely necessary.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Monet Bags

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The object that borrows your face has something above its reflection.*
- 2 *The painted world draws your gaze. The clue prefers its hidden reverse.*
- 3 *A soft cushion in the color of a clear sky conceals something behind it.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Monet Bags

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Monet Bags

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I moved restricted money without authorization. Payroll would have failed before the donation arrived. Grant discovered the transfer and demanded his wing expenses added to it. He could report me for the first transaction while benefiting from the second. I knew what that report would cost.

IF MURDERER

I moved restricted money without authorization. Payroll would have failed before the donation arrived. Grant discovered the transfer and demanded his wing expenses added to it. He could report me for the first transaction while benefiting from the second. I had no intention of letting him do that.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Monet Bags

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Monet Bags

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The bank called about the restricted account during the reception. I went to the office to stop the transfer being reversed before payroll cleared. There was no board authorization. Grant found me there and offered to overlook it if I added the marble-wing expenses. I refused. He wrote the proposed addition on the ledger, and I pulled the page away before his leaking pen obscured the amounts.

IF MURDERER

The bank called about the restricted account during the reception. I went to the office to stop the transfer being reversed before payroll cleared. There was no board authorization. Grant found me there and offered to overlook it if I added the marble-wing expenses. I refused. He wrote the proposed addition on the ledger, and I pulled the page away before his leaking pen obscured the amounts.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Monet Bags

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Monet Bags

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The bank retained the payroll instruction and the board received no authorization from me. Grant's handwritten marble-wing addition is on the ledger I took away from the office. His leaking pen stained the schedule beneath it. The original records salaries and his proposed expense separately. It corroborates the transfer I made and the addition I refused, without making my transfer lawful.

IF MURDERER

My unauthorized transfer covered salaries. Grant's proposed addition covered a likeness of himself. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my ledger. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. Later, in the salon, I pushed his empty glass aside while he signed the revised payroll schedule. That was after our argument in the office.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Monet Bags

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

**Monet Bags**

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I moved restricted money to pay staff and did it without authorization. The bank's instruction and the marked ledger separate that transfer from Grant's marble-wing proposal. I did not poison him. I will account for the money I moved. The wing expenses will not disappear into the wages while I do it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my ledger when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He threatened to expose my transfer while making me conceal his expenses. I made the account end with him.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Chip Patina

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Chip Patina

Chief Conservator

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Your other secret

You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Cary Crates has noticed the altered treatment date.
- Ask Dr. Art E. Fact what he thinks the Star Bowl's modern adhesive means.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*
- 2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*
- 3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Chip Patina

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed a treatment date to meet an insurance deadline. That mistake was mine. Grant wanted a recent repair described as ancient, so that damage would become part of the object's pedigree. I could correct the date. Once my report went into the exhibition file, people would quote it for years. I refused to give him that report.

IF MURDERER

I changed a treatment date to meet an insurance deadline. That mistake was mine. Grant wanted a recent repair described as ancient, so that damage would become part of the object's pedigree. He had seen me compromise one record and assumed I would do it again. I resented how easily he made the second request.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Chip Patina

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Chip Patina

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I had changed the treatment date to meet the insurance deadline. During the walkthrough I replaced the bottle's museum custody band and recorded its condition. Later the crew asked me about the mounting fault. Grant wanted that described as an ancient repair. I went to the closed alcove to look at the defect instead of agreeing with him. My supply sleeve contains unused red foil-backed band strips; they are ordinary stock from our shared materials cabinet.

IF MURDERER

I had changed the treatment date to meet the insurance deadline. During the walkthrough I replaced the bottle's museum custody band and recorded its condition. Later the crew asked me about the mounting fault. Grant wanted that described as an ancient repair. I went to the closed alcove to look at the defect instead of agreeing with him. My supply sleeve contains unused red foil-backed band strips; they are ordinary stock from our shared materials cabinet.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Chip Patina

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Chip Patina

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The changed date is on the insurance copy. The original treatment photograph shows the mount before the alteration, and the technician kept that original. I went to the closed alcove to check the defect the crew had reported. The closure notice concerns a real fault; it does not authenticate the date I put on the insurance copy. I will correct that copy. Grant wanted me to authenticate a much larger fiction. The inventory lists unused custody-band stock in my supply sleeve; the before-tour condition photograph records the new band I applied.

IF MURDERER

I substituted the dated treatment copy for the original Grant had been waving at the insurer. The insurance copy has the altered date. I wanted the original out of Grant's hands before he talked to the insurer. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my treatment file. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass before laying down the dated treatment copy.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Chip Patina

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I falsified the insurance date. The technician's original photograph records the actual treatment, and the later mounting fault was real. The red strips in my supply sleeve were unused custody-band stock. I did not kill Grant. I will correct the insurance file and accept responsibility for that alteration instead of signing another one.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my treatment file when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He held my altered date over me and wanted another false report. I silenced him instead of correcting the first one.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dada DiCapo

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

- Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.
- **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.
- Has made commissioned work for **Tess Tament**. **Tess** still asks whether one piece is meant to make that noise.
- Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Dada DiCapo

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Your other secret

You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Conversations to start

- Enjoy watching people overreact to your warning note without admitting you wrote it.
- Find out whether Minnie Malist changed the lighting cue you designed.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



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The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*
- 2 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*
- 3 *A secret waits behind drapes the color of spilled wine.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Yes, I wrote the warning. Returning what was taken meant my performance concept, which Grant planned to unveil with himself credited as visionary patron. It was a provocation. He turned my work into an advertisement and then complained that the artist had supplied an uncomfortable caption.

IF MURDERER

I wrote the warning and meant Grant to feel threatened. He had taken my unreleased performance, stripped out the difficult parts, and awarded himself the credit. He called his version accessible. Theft is quite accessible when somebody else pays for the stage.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.

IF MURDERER

I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.



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Dada DiCapo

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Dada DiCapo

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The rehearsal photograph shows an empty jacket on a hinged stand. No drink was used in the effect. The stage manager kept the canceled sequence and my notebook sketch, including the original credit. The red foil-backed scraps in my program came from the closing confetti, cut from the shared materials stock. I intended a fake collapse and a public embarrassment. The retained plan records what that effect actually involved.

IF MURDERER

I wrote the warning. The stage manager had my unapproved revision. Grant wanted his foundation's credit restored before the performance. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my working program. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to leave the revised program beside it.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Dada DiCapo

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I intended to run the canceled performance. The jacket on the stand was empty, and the rehearsal used no drink. The metallic paper came from our closing effect. I did not poison Grant. I wanted his name taken off my work in front of the donors. I will admit the unauthorized plan and insist that the surviving sketch retain its actual credit.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my working program when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He took my work and credited his foundation. I made the closing reveal a murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Vincent Van Faux

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a documentary. He is truly a genius of the visual arts. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Went to art school with **Dada DiCapo**. **Dada** enjoys reminding Vincent of this in front of collectors.
- **Hugh Bidder** wants to represent Vincent. Vincent has yet to approve **Hugh**'s percentage.
- **Penny Pincher** keeps showing Vincent photos of paintings and asking what they are worth. He's not interested.
- **Al Baster** compares their commissions by weight. Vincent would prefer to discuss the price.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Vincent Van Faux. My new work is here tonight. My early work is also here, despite several very expensive objections.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Your other secret

You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Ella Gance knows you were behind the anonymous buybacks.
- Persuade Claire O'Scuro that the student painting should not be displayed.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find the biography of the man who chose conscience over obedience. Its pages have company.*
- 2 *Look inside the vessel that usually gives cut flowers a place to stand.*
- 3 *Find the green light, then examine the space nearby.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous buybacks were mine. I paid to remove my student paintings from circulation. Grant owned the worst one and wanted it beside my recent work as a joke. A patron buying art is charming. A patron buying the right to humiliate its painter is a different transaction.

IF MURDERER

I arranged the buybacks because early work should sometimes remain early work. Grant refused to sell his student painting back. He wanted the gala to laugh at it. He had never painted anything, yet tonight he intended to become the author of my reputation.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I turned my student painting toward the wall and removed its sale notice. Grant had positioned it beside the new work without asking me. I had brought cash to buy it back; he would not name a price. The registrar told me to restore the display. I restored the painting and kept the notice. There was a blank space where I had painted over my own signature years ago. I did not need that pointed out to the room.

IF MURDERER

I turned my student painting toward the wall and removed its sale notice. Grant had positioned it beside the new work without asking me. I had brought cash to buy it back; he would not name a price. The registrar told me to restore the display. I restored the painting and kept the notice. There was a blank space where I had painted over my own signature years ago. I did not need that pointed out to the room.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Vincent Van Faux

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Vincent Van Faux

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The replacement sketch is on the back of the student picture's sale notice. The painted-out signature is mine. I prepared the cash before the gala and took it home again when Grant refused. The notice and withdrawal receipt corroborate the buyback I tried to conceal. A very expensive lesson in being ashamed of one's own work.

IF MURDERER

Grant rejected my replacement sketch. The signature I painted over was mine; I wanted the student work taken out of the exhibition. I had prepared cash for the purchase and did not want its owner to know what I would pay. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sketch wallet. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before spreading out the replacement sketch.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I bought my own early paintings back and tried to buy this one too. I was ashamed of it. The sale notice and cash withdrawal survive; I can stop pretending those purchases were anonymous collectors. I did not murder Grant. The registrar can hang the student picture beside the new one. I will have to survive the comparison.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my sketch wallet when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He planned to use my old painting to humiliate me. I murdered my patron rather than endure his unveiling.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Sue Venir

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Sue Venir

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Your other secret

Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Conversations to start

- Learn whether Mona Lott has obtained a copy of your original memo.
- Keep Dr. Art E. Fact from publicly speculating about your legal advice.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*
- 2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*
- 3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had let the account matter more than the advice. Hearing him use that compromise as my endorsement was unbearable.

IF MURDERER

I softened the legal opinion and failed to correct Grant when he called it clearance. Both versions still identify a problem with the title. He wanted my name in the announcement and my qualifications left out. I had made myself useful to him by saying less. Now he expected my signature on a claim I did not believe.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.

IF MURDERER

I took a call from opposing counsel in the coatroom. Grant wanted my revised opinion read as clearance of the collection. It was not. I had softened the wording and failed to object when he described it that way. Counsel asked which version would be supplied to the board. I said both. Grant heard the end of that answer and told me there would be consequences for embarrassing his gift.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Sue Venir

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Sue Venir

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I retained both legal opinions. The earlier one names the missing permit; the softened version does not withdraw that finding. My assistant's outgoing email has the earlier attachment. I let Grant describe a rewrite as a clearance. The file can show what I actually advised, even if I did not object loudly enough.

IF MURDERER

I softened the legal opinion for Grant and kept the earlier version. He wanted me to call the ownership finding settled. I took the annex away before he could keep my name beside that claim. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my legal case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass to keep the signature page flat.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Sue Venir

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

**Sue Venir**

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I softened the opinion and allowed Grant to imply it cleared the collection. The earlier version still names the missing permit. I did not kill him. Both opinions will go to the board, including the language I weakened. Advice becomes less useful when the lawyer helps a client conceal what it actually says.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my legal case when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He used my softened opinion as permission to keep what he could not prove he owned. I ended the argument by killing my client.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Dr. Art E. Fact

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises **Reed DeLabel**'s doctoral research and sends drafts back covered in notes.
- Secretly infatuated with the enigmatic energy of **Dada DiCapo**. Will she notice him?
- Trusts only **Chip Patina** to say when the physical evidence contradicts Art's theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Dr. Art E. Fact. I bring decades of scholarship and a footnote for almost every possible dinner conversation. Looking forward to intellectual discussions tonight!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Your other secret

One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Conversations to start

- Ask Reed DeLabel what he has discovered in the accession records.
- Determine whether Claire O'Scuro commissioned outside provenance research.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Your reflection cannot look up far enough to see what rests on the mirror.*
- 2 *Look behind a painting rather than into its scenery.*
- 3 *The household's Bible has received a very unofficial insert.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

One inference in my article goes beyond the source. I had sent a correction to the archivist before coming here. Grant wanted the entire article withdrawn. He spoke as though finding one bad sentence made him the better historian. I was embarrassed by the sentence and furious at being asked to abandon the evidence around it.

IF MURDERER

One inference in my article goes beyond the source. I had sent a correction to the archivist before coming here. Grant wanted the entire article withdrawn. He spoke as though finding one bad sentence made him the better historian. I had spent years on that research, and I could not bear to hear him dismiss it in front of the collection.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I corrected the citation on the display and then had to correct my own explanation of it. My published inference went beyond the source. Grant wanted a public withdrawal of the whole article. I offered a correction to the sentence that was wrong. We argued in front of the collection rather than in his private room. I wanted the object examined; he wanted my error to end the examination.

IF MURDERER

I corrected the citation on the display and then had to correct my own explanation of it. My published inference went beyond the source. Grant wanted a public withdrawal of the whole article. I offered a correction to the sentence that was wrong. We argued in front of the collection rather than in his private room. I wanted the object examined; he wanted my error to end the examination.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The archive reference confirms the ownership question, but it does not support one sentence in my article. My notes distinguish the passage I read from the inference I added. I sent the archivist my correction before the gala. That is the error Grant had found, and the correspondence verifies it.

IF MURDERER

I corrected the citation Grant had found wanting. I did not intend to withdraw the ownership challenge with it. He wanted the article discredited as a whole, and I wanted the archive reference considered separately. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my citation folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while showing him the amended reference.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dr. Art E. Fact

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The inference in my article needs correction. I will publish it. The source still raises the ownership question, and the correspondence records exactly which sentence was mine. I did not poison Grant. An error in my work is not a reason to preserve a separate error in the exhibition.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my citation folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He meant to buy my silence with my own citation error. I protected the article by committing a crime far worse than its mistake.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Tess Tament

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

- Knows **Hugh Bidder** from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.
- Has commissioned work from **Dada DiCapo** and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.
- Asks **Mona Lott** which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Tess Tament. I represent the family foundation. Contrary to what some here may think, being related to a donor is a responsibility, not a cash machine.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Your other secret

You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Anya Tique would publicly oppose renaming the museum.
- Gauge Artie Ficial's willingness to reject Grant's conditions.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1** *A piano's electric cousin is hiding a note that cannot be played. Look beneath it.*
- 2** *Spain has a clue for you. Find Barcelona without leaving the house.*
- 3** *The blue cushion is comfortable. Its secret is not meant to stay buried.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant called me ornamental. Then he demanded my signature on the family trust. Apparently ornaments can execute legal documents. I organized the trustees against him. The money was supposed to support people, and his new plan mostly supported a very expensive sign saying GRANT.

IF MURDERER

Grant called me ornamental while waving a trust amendment that would remove my vote. I organized the trustees against him, but he had enough signatures to destroy our plan tonight. He thought I would cry beautifully and approve the paperwork. I had finished being useful decoration.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Tess Tament

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.

IF MURDERER

I was calling trustees from the cloakroom, trying to assemble enough votes to block Grant's amendment. I told one of them the others had already agreed. They had not. When Grant asked for my signature, I refused and told him the vote was settled. It was a bluff. I went back to the phone before he could call the trustees himself. The family trust was not supposed to become his private naming fund.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Tess Tament

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:31. My entrance receipt records my first admission at 6:31. The trustee calls were made from the cloakroom after that arrival. The phone log and the written objection corroborate the revolt I was organizing. I bluffed about having enough votes; I did not obtain the missing votes by getting a signature from Grant.

IF MURDERER

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:17. My entrance receipt documents the admission I described. I took the trustees' objection to Grant myself. He mistook a carefully dressed woman for an agreeable signature. The objection was meant to correct that mistake in writing. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying down the trustees' objection.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Tess Tament

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The trustee revolt was mine, including the bluff about having enough votes. My entrance receipt records my first arrival at 6:31, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will tell the trustees which promises I had actually obtained. Then I will ask them to vote against the amendment without claiming the vote is already won.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my evening bag when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He treated my inheritance and my vote as his possessions. I murdered him before the trustees heard his version.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Barb Dwyer

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Barb Dwyer

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Your other secret

You personally ordered the technician to unplug the camera despite museum policy. The work order records the disconnection, but you never documented Grant's threat to make security take the blame.

Conversations to start

- Find out who knew the Donor Salon camera was offline.
- Ask Artie Ficial why Grant wanted the Donor Salon camera switched off. Keep your own part in that decision private for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*
- 2 *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*
- 3 *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I ordered the camera disconnected. Grant authorized it; the security procedure did not. He wanted privacy and intended to blame my staff if something went wrong. I followed his order and concealed the exception. The officer giving that instruction was me.

IF MURDERER

I ordered the camera disconnected. Grant authorized it; the security procedure did not. He wanted privacy and intended to blame my staff if something went wrong. I followed his order and concealed the exception. I was not willing to be his explanation for the consequences.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I had the technician unplug the salon camera. Grant's written instruction authorized it; the safety procedure did not. I checked the gallery doorway camera afterward and left that one running. Then I dealt with the entrance queue. Grant had told me security would take the blame for any problem. I kept his order in my jacket instead of filing the exception report. I knew exactly which part I was failing to document.

IF MURDERER

I had the technician unplug the salon camera. Grant's written instruction authorized it; the safety procedure did not. I checked the gallery doorway camera afterward and left that one running. Then I dealt with the entrance queue. Grant had told me security would take the blame for any problem. I kept his order in my jacket instead of filing the exception report. I knew exactly which part I was failing to document.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The authorization in my jacket bears Grant's signature. The technician kept the disconnected cable and the work order. I was checking the gallery door when the outage began, then returned to the public entrance. The doorway camera remained active. I concealed his threat to blame security because I thought obeying his written order would protect my staff. That was poor judgment. The camera order itself was his.

IF MURDERER

Grant ordered the Salon camera disconnected for his private meeting. The camera order bears Grant's signature. He wanted the private discussion kept away from the gallery recording. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my work-order sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while checking the place setting after the outage.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Barb Dwyer

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I authorized the camera exception and concealed it from the report. Grant signed the order, but I was responsible for following the security procedure. The work order and active doorway camera survive. I did not poison him. My staff will receive the actual authorization, and I will answer for the exception I failed to file.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my work-order sleeve when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. I obeyed his camera order and used the privacy it created. I murdered the man who intended to blame my staff.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Paige Turner

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Paige Turner

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You were investigating Grant's collection and labor dealings. He threatened an injunction and demanded the name of your museum source as the price of withdrawing it. He confiscated your recorder after you refused.

Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*
- 2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*
- 3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. The person who trusted me was not a term I could trade in a settlement.

IF MURDERER

Grant threatened the report, my source and the paper's ability to publish. I had made a factual error he could use. I corrected that sentence and refused the name he wanted. He intended to get that name whether the settlement was signed or not.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.

IF MURDERER

I recovered my recorder from the side pocket of Grant's coat. He had taken it after I refused to name my source. I went into the cloakroom without permission and copied the recording before he could demand it deleted. The conversation included his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. I had also corrected the sentence his lawyer challenged. Those are separate decisions. I intended to preserve evidence of both.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The recorder contains Grant's offer to withdraw the injunction for my source's name. My editor retained both the original report and the separate factual correction. My editor had received an earlier copy before Grant took the recorder. The recovered file matches that copy. I concealed the source and took back evidence without permission. The timestamps and the editor's copies corroborate those decisions. They do not require the source to trust Grant's promise.

IF MURDERER

That thick red line deletes the description that could identify my source. I handed Grant a working carbon. My editor retained the original. The deletion was deliberate, and I will defend it. Grant could challenge the reporting without buying the person who helped me do it. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my reporter's notebook. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass so he could mark the proof.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Paige Turner

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

**Paige Turner**

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I refused my source's name and took the recorder back without permission. My editor already held the recording and the factual correction. I did not kill Grant. I will publish the correction and retain his offer to withdraw the injunction for a name. Protecting the source does not excuse the sentence I got wrong; correcting it does not require surrendering them.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my reporter's notebook when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He demanded my source's name. I called murder protecting a source. It was murder, and the correction I owed my readers still stands.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Frank Lloyd Wrong

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Exhibition Architect & Designer

Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal.

- **Chip Patina** can veto Frank's display designs. Frank tends to take the veto personally.
- **Elle Loominate** has worked on Frank's exhibition spaces. They vehemently disagree about how much room a textile needs.
- **Dada DiCapo** once described one of Frank's galleries as "an expensive corridor." Frank remembers the review.
- **Al Baster** insists the entrance was designed around his sculpture. Frank insists the sculpture was sized for his entrance.

ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Frank Lloyd Wrong. I designed all the displays you see around the gallery. If one more person says they have one tiny last-minute change, I'm gonna scream!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Your other secret

You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Conversations to start

- Keep Chip Patina from turning the temporary rig into a formal safety dispute.
- Find out what Minnie Malist changed after your final walkthrough.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A German pastor's life story has acquired an uninvited appendix.*
- 2 *The household collection behind a cupboard door includes an unexpected exhibit.*
- 3 *The garage's broad doorway has acquired an exhibit overhead. Ask for help reaching it.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I approved a temporary installation below my own standard. Grant demanded more load and threatened to withhold payment when I objected. I should have stopped the work earlier. He intended to use my first signature as approval of something I would not sign now.

IF MURDERER

I approved a temporary installation below my own standard. Grant demanded more load and threatened to withhold payment when I objected. I should have stopped the work earlier. He had decided my first signature mattered more than the defect I was reporting.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took down the first approval tag on the installation. It carried my signature on a load figure I should not have accepted. The crew thought I was clearing the fault. I was trying to remove the record of my earlier mistake. I then told the rigger to keep the alcove shut and issue an accurate stop-work sheet. Grant demanded it reopened for photographs. I refused to put the original tag back.

IF MURDERER

I took down the first approval tag on the installation. It carried my signature on a load figure I should not have accepted. The crew thought I was clearing the fault. I was trying to remove the record of my earlier mistake. I then told the rigger to keep the alcove shut and issue an accurate stop-work sheet. Grant demanded it reopened for photographs. I refused to put the original tag back.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The crossed-out load figure is mine. The rigger's stop-work sheet records that I kept the alcove closed after Grant demanded it reopened. I inspected the installation with the crew; their work photographs show the support I refused to approve. I had signed the earlier note and wanted it replaced with an accurate one. The new drawing would cost me the contract. It would also keep the installation from falling on someone.

IF MURDERER

I had signed an installation note I should have challenged. The crossed-out load figure is mine. Grant wanted the earlier approval used for the photographs. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my drawing tube. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved the glass while spreading the support drawing.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACCUSATIONS



Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Frank Lloyd Wrong

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I removed an approval tag bearing my own inadequate load figure. Then I required the alcove to stay closed. The rigger kept the new stop-work sheet and the crew photographs. I did not murder Grant. The corrected drawing will identify my earlier error, not quietly replace it. The crew deserves a record it can build from.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my drawing tube when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted my signature on an unsafe installation. I killed him instead of putting my refusal on the record.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Mona Lott

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.
- Secretly wants to fool **Tess Tament** into paying millions for cheap bead necklaces from China.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Mona Lott

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Paige Turner knows you were the leak.
- Get Sue Venir to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*
- 2 *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*
- 3 *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I did it because the announcement would otherwise become the only account guests heard.

IF MURDERER

I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I wanted that announcement prevented, not merely answered afterward.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.

IF MURDERER

I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The delegation kept my original amendment. It calls the work a loan, reserves the owner's right to recall it, and removes Grant's permanent-ownership claim. I leaked the negotiations before the partners approved that wording. The version history identifies the leak and the clause I was trying to protect. It does not give Grant title to the work.

IF MURDERER

I had leaked the negotiations before the partners approved them. Grant wanted my amendment removed and the permanent gift announced. I used the delegation's letterhead without permission to resist that announcement. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my letter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to keep the delegation's amendment open.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Mona Lott

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Mona Lott

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I leaked the negotiations and obstructed the unveiling without the partners' consent. Their retained amendment calls the work a loan. I did not poison Grant. I will admit the leak to them and give the owner the full account of tonight's dispute. A dead donor does not settle an ownership claim.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my letter folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. I wanted him stopped before the ownership announcement. I chose his death over another failed negotiation.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Elon Mosaic

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Elon Mosaic

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron

Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to get people to appreciate his taste as a collector rather than just his net worth.

- Buys everything through **Hugh Bidder** but pretends he found the art himself.
- Knows **Tess Tament** from the collector circuit. They compare acquisitions whenever they meet.
- Keeps pitching museum technology to **Monet Bags**. **Monet** asks for the price before the demonstration.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Elon Mosaic. I collect art. Some people collect grudges about the art I collect. Both are expensive hobbies.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Your other secret

You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Conversations to start

- Keep Hugh Bidder from revealing your role in the auction.
- Find out whether Artie Ficial supports your board candidacy.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A looking glass shows almost everything. Its upper edge is less forthcoming.*
- 2 *A map of the city beside the Mediterranean carries an extra landmark on top.*
- 3 *Look behind the pillow wearing the color of the deep sea.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I was the anonymous buyer; Hugh bid for me to avoid a contest with Grant. I also negotiated a board position without telling the other bidders who owned the company on the invoice. Grant lost the object but still expected to decide whether I belonged at the museum. I disliked needing his approval more than I wanted the seat.

IF MURDERER

I was the anonymous buyer; Hugh bid for me to avoid a contest with Grant. I also negotiated a board position without telling the other bidders who owned the company on the invoice. Grant lost the object but still expected to decide whether I belonged at the museum. Every discussion of the purchase became another occasion for him to put me in my place.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I made the counteroffer over speakerphone beside the auction display. I did not tell the other bidders that the company on the invoice was mine. Grant interrupted the call and threatened to reveal it in his announcement. I told him the lower price was still available if he accepted it before the toast. He wanted my board appointment withdrawn instead. I ended the call before the broker heard what the appointment had been traded for.

IF MURDERER

I made the counteroffer over speakerphone beside the auction display. I did not tell the other bidders that the company on the invoice was mine. Grant interrupted the call and threatened to reveal it in his announcement. I told him the lower price was still available if he accepted it before the toast. He wanted my board appointment withdrawn instead. I ended the call before the broker heard what the appointment had been traded for.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The auction invoice names the company through which I bought the piece. I omitted that connection from my pitch. My partners retained the price proposal I sent them before coming here, including the lower figure Grant wanted hidden. The concealed purchase was real. So was the offer he wanted me to deny having made.

IF MURDERER

The auction purchase went through my company. I concealed that connection in the proposal. Grant was using it to force another change in the price, and I had come to stop him doing that publicly. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my proposal folio. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to make room for the revised price page.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The bidder's company was mine. I concealed that connection and negotiated a board position alongside the purchase. The invoice and my partners' price proposal survive. I did not kill Grant. I will disclose both transactions before asking the museum to consider either proposal. There is no useful version of that disclosure with my company left out.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my proposal folio when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He threatened my appointment and my concealed purchase. I treated a person as an obstacle I could remove.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anya Tique

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired **Artie Ficial** early in his career.
- Trusts **Chip Patina** and **Anne E. Dote**.
- Has known **Tess Tament** since **Tess** was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anya Tique. I helped build this museum. Tonight I reserve the right to judge the lighting and everyone in it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Anya Tique

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Your other secret

You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Conversations to start

- Ask Artie Ficial whether the naming agreement preserves the museum you founded.
- Ask Tess Tament what she thinks Grant expects from his family tonight.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Where fingers conduct a row of musical keys, a clue waits underneath.*
- 2 *Behind a crimson curtain, the museum has misplaced a document.*
- 3 *The clue has chosen the place where ice cream refuses to melt.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

In 1989 I accepted Grant's donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I was ashamed of the first decision and angry at what he thought it entitled him to.

IF MURDERER

In 1989 I accepted Grant's donation with papers still missing. The museum needed money, and I believed his promise that they would follow. I had built part of this institution on that promise. Tonight he wanted my old signature treated as permission to do it again. I could not accept that this was what the museum I helped found had become.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.

IF MURDERER

I went to the accession drawer and replaced the exhibition copy of the 1989 record with a photocopy that left out my handwritten exception. I had accepted incomplete papers then and was concealing that compromise again. Grant found the original entry and asked whether I remembered signing it. I did. I took the photocopy back out of the drawer. The original register was still there when the archivist checked it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Anya Tique

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Anya Tique

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:30. The staffed guest book records the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist.

IF MURDERER

The staffed entrance admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The staffed guest book documents the first admission I described. My signature on the accession shows that I accepted an incomplete file. It does not make the promised export document exist. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my accession file. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before putting down the accession record.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACCUSATIONS



Anya Tique

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Anya Tique

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I accepted the incomplete file in 1989 and concealed my exception again tonight. The archivist retained the original register. I first entered at 6:30, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will restore the complete accession record, including my own handwriting, and stop treating promised papers as papers received.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my accession file when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. The old accession file could disgrace me. I killed Grant before he could use it in front of the donors.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Saul D. Bid

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of **Hugh Bidder**.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Saul D. Bid. Going once, going twice—no, I am only asking someone to pass the bread.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Saul D. Bid

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Conversations to start

- Compare notes with Hugh Bidder about Grant's demands on auction houses.
- Ask Elon Mosaic what he expects from tonight's unveiling. Keep your private sale to yourself for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A screen steals every eye. The evidence has slipped out of view behind it.*
- 2 *The award has already been won. Its underside offers another reward.*
- 3 *The clue is keeping company with the lamp in green.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I routed the sale through a subsidiary. The client demanded discretion, and I supplied a discreet invoice with an indiscreet fee. Grant threatened to expose the arrangement unless I waived that fee. He admired confidentiality until someone charged him for it.

IF MURDERER

The subsidiary sale was mine. Grant wanted the fee waived and the arrangement buried. Otherwise he would announce it tonight as my personal scandal. I have auctioned many ugly objects. His proposal had particularly poor proportions.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.

IF MURDERER

I disclosed my client's ceiling price in a private auction call. Grant used it to demand that I waive the commission. I tried to arrange an off-book fee through the subsidiary instead. The client was not told. I spent the reception switching between that call and the bidding conversation, hoping to close the sale before either party compared notes. My service to the client was becoming expensive in ways the client had not authorized.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Saul D. Bid

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Saul D. Bid

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My client gave me a ceiling price in writing. I disclosed it to Grant against instructions. The sale book and the client's original message establish the transaction I was trying to rescue. I have made a client's negotiating position considerably worse. Turning that mistake into a murder accusation will not improve it.

IF MURDERER

I disclosed my client's ceiling price to Grant. The folded sheet was supposed to repair the resulting fee dispute. Grant now knew which part of the sale I could not afford to have described honestly. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my sale book. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass out of the way of the private fee statement.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Saul D. Bid

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Saul D. Bid

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I disclosed the client's ceiling and tried to hide the resulting fee through a subsidiary. The original message and sale book establish it. I did not murder Grant. The client will receive both. I may find myself negotiating my own refund, which will be a less enjoyable auction than the one I intended to conduct tonight.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my sale book when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted my fee waived and my client exposed. I made a private commission the excuse for murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Elle Loominate

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Elle Loominate

Textile Artist & Designer

Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has helped **Dada DiCapo** build several installations.
- Asks **Chip Patina** how to display fragile textiles without making the supports the main attraction.
- Has worked in **Frank Lloyd Wrong**'s exhibition spaces. **Frank**'s empty walls look like opportunities to Elle.

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Elle Loominate. I make installations with light and fabric. Please do not describe either as something your nephew could do.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Your other secret

The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Conversations to start

- Ask Chip Patina how you can protect the ceremonial textile without selling it.
- Ask Dada DiCapo whether the gala has become more about donors than artists.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Dietrich's story belongs on a bookshelf. Tonight something else belongs between its covers.*
- 2 *No petals are needed: the vase holds a different kind of arrangement.*
- 3 *A clue watches the cars come and go from above the garage door.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I promised the textile without obtaining my family's consent. Grant offered to purchase it and call the problem settled. The people who made it had not given me that right. I was trying to withdraw a promise that I should not have made, and he intended to announce possession anyway.

IF MURDERER

I promised the textile without obtaining my family's consent. Grant offered to purchase it and call the problem settled. The people who made it had not given me that right. I was trying to withdraw the promise, and I wanted his announcement stopped.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I unpinned the family textile from the proposed display arrangement. Grant's caption called it his permanent gift. I had offered it on loan elsewhere and had not obtained the family consent I needed for either promise. I folded it away while the installer argued with me. Grant offered a purchase price. I told him the cloth was not mine to sell, which I should have admitted before offering it in the first place.

IF MURDERER

I unpinned the family textile from the proposed display arrangement. Grant's caption called it his permanent gift. I had offered it on loan elsewhere and had not obtained the family consent I needed for either promise. I folded it away while the installer argued with me. Grant offered a purchase price. I told him the cloth was not mine to sell, which I should have admitted before offering it in the first place.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The other institution kept my signed loan offer and the dated pattern photographs. I had promised work I was no longer free to promise. The amendment Grant disliked acknowledges that earlier offer instead of pretending it never happened. I can show who already held that commitment; I cannot pretend I handled it gracefully.

IF MURDERER

I had offered the textile to another institution. Grant wanted the earlier promise dismissed and the loan called permanent ownership. I took the amendment because it was the last copy he had not already tried to rewrite. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my pattern folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while unfolding the loan amendment.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I promised the textile without the family consent either institution needed. The dated loan offer survives. I did not poison Grant. I will tell both institutions about the conflicting promises and return the decision to the people entitled to make it. Folding the cloth away tonight did not withdraw the earlier offer.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my pattern folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted to keep the textile and expose my second promise. I killed him rather than face the institution I had misled.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Reed DeLabel

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History

Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supervises Reed's doctorate and rarely returns a clean draft.
- Gets informal guidance from **Claire O'Scuro** on exhibition labels and curatorial work.
- Checks dates and catalog references for **Paige Turner**. Reed saves any article that includes a correction.
- **Anne E. Dote** coaches Reed through gallery tours. She keeps crossing footnotes out of the children's handouts.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Reed DeLabel. I am the graduate fellow. I know where the footnotes go and, more dangerously, where they are missing.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Your other secret

You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Conversations to start

- Ask Claire O'Scuro whether she is comfortable with the Star Bowl label.
- Ask Dr. Art E. Fact how a junior researcher should challenge a donor's version of history.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Four legs and a metallic seat guard a secret from below.*
- 2 *Behind a cupboard's closed doors, one item has no domestic purpose.*
- 3 *Seek the sacred book with two testaments. Tonight its pages shelter evidence.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I copied a reference too quickly and concealed what the original meant for Art's research. Correcting it would embarrass him as well as me. Grant wanted the old attribution restored because it suited the exhibition. I was expected to take responsibility for the careless note and then keep repeating it. I wanted somebody to read the source before deciding what my work was worth.

IF MURDERER

I copied a reference too quickly and concealed what the original meant for Art's research. Correcting it would embarrass him as well as me. Grant wanted the old attribution restored because it suited the exhibition. I was expected to take responsibility for the careless note and then keep repeating it. He treated my fellowship as a reason I would obey him.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Reed DeLabel

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I found the reference book shelved under the wrong collection and checked the entry I had copied too quickly. It contradicted the exhibition label and my own working note. I changed the online catalog before asking permission. Grant wanted the old attribution restored before guests looked it up. I kept the source register open on the desk so the archivist could see why I had changed it. My shortcut was no longer a private mistake.

IF MURDERER

I found the reference book shelved under the wrong collection and checked the entry I had copied too quickly. It contradicted the exhibition label and my own working note. I changed the online catalog before asking permission. Grant wanted the old attribution restored before guests looked it up. I kept the source register open on the desk so the archivist could see why I had changed it. My shortcut was no longer a private mistake.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Reed DeLabel

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The source register identifies the entry I copied without checking. The archivist's reply supplies the correct attribution. I retained both because destroying my notes would not change the object. My shorthand became an exhibition claim it could not support. That is the misconduct the correspondence explains.

IF MURDERER

I copied the unchecked reference into the catalog. Grant wanted me to repeat that attribution over the archivist's objection. I retrieved my notes because I did not want the careless sentence to become my permanent contribution. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my reference sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to put the disputed sentences side by side.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Reed DeLabel

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I copied an attribution without checking and concealed that the source also undermined Art's research. The register and archivist's reply identify both mistakes. I did not kill Grant. I will correct my catalog entry and tell Art what I found. A junior researcher can admit a shortcut without asking everyone else to keep the wrong attribution.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my reference sleeve when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He could take my fellowship and turn my unchecked reference against Art. I chose murder instead of publishing the correction.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.
- Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.
- **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Al Baster

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong whether the entrance display still includes your original sculpture.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux how he handles patrons who try to replace an artist's work.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*
- 2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*
- 3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed the sculpture's support and left the fabricator's contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me. Seeing their work treated as something to discard made that failure harder to excuse.

IF MURDERER

I changed the sculpture's support and left the fabricator's contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me, and I was watching him turn months of our work into an opening-night prop.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.

IF MURDERER

I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The fabricator's name is on the drawing I retained. The plaster on my hands came from opening the sculpture's temporary support for the crew. Their installation photographs show the replacement Grant had ordered and my original beside it. I had concealed a departure from the approved plan. I was trying to correct that record before he used the photographs to call my sculpture a replica of his replacement.

IF MURDERER

After opening the support panel, I kept my work apron on. Grant was still talking about replacing the sculpture as though the people who made it had never existed. In the salon I lifted his empty glass and offered a toast to the fabricator whose name I had left off the work. I put it back. I had not suddenly become generous about credit; I wanted him embarrassed before he embarrassed me. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap in my apron pocket. I wore that apron on the preparation walkthrough too. The drawing identifies the worker I should have credited from the beginning.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Al Baster

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Al Baster

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I changed the support from the approved plan and omitted the fabricator's credit. The drawing and shop photographs establish both. I did not poison Grant. I will correct the construction record, credit the workers and settle their invoices before disputing my own balance. His proposed replica does not erase my original obligations.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. The mock toast gave me a reason to lift it. A fragment of the bottle's custody band remained in my work-apron pocket; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and I had admitted wearing the apron at both places. He intended to replace my sculpture and refuse the balance. I killed him over the contract and pretended I was defending the people whose credit I had withheld.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Ella Gance

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Ella Gance

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Your other secret

You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Conversations to start

- Ask Vincent Van Faux what the museum expects a collector to donate.
- Compare gala expectations with Elon Mosaic. Keep your withdrawn donation private for now.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*
- 2 *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*
- 3 *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I had invited people to see me thanked for something I could not deliver.

IF MURDERER

I sold the work I had promised to donate. A failed investment made the promise unaffordable. I hoped to bring a replacement before anyone asked. Grant knew where the original had gone and intended to reveal it in his announcement. I wanted him stopped before the room heard that story.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.

IF MURDERER

I stopped the assistant from unpacking the replacement work I had brought. It was not the piece I promised, and I wanted time to explain before it reached the donor display. Grant asked where the original was. I said it was unavailable; I had sold it. The assistant kept the packing list. I had come dressed to be thanked for a donation I could no longer make. I was trying to keep that fact out of the photographs.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:32.
The entrance record is my first admission at 6:32. The assistant retained the replacement work's packing list and photographed it before unpacking. It is not the work I promised. The sale invoice predates tonight, and the failed investment is mine. The packing records corroborate the substitution I was trying to conceal.

IF MURDERER

The entrance attendant admitted me for the first time at 6:16. The entrance record confirms the first admission I described. I folded the silk wrapping while he read. The replacement would conceal my failed promise. It was a financial compromise I should have explained to the institution expecting the original. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my evening bag. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while presenting the replacement offer.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Ella Gance

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Ella Gance

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I sold the promised donation and brought a replacement I hoped nobody would unpack too quickly. My first arrival was 6:32, after the bottle was locked away. I did not kill Grant. I will notify the institution expecting the original and offer repayment. The packing list can say what I brought without calling it what I promised.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my evening bag when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He had the correspondence about the promise I could not fulfill. I killed him before the announcement instead of answering for it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Drew Conclusions

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of **Paige Turner**.
- Has reviewed **Vincent Van Faux**, **Dada DiCapo**, **Al Baster**, and **Elle Loominate**.
- **Elon Mosaic** remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Drew Conclusions. I review art professionally. My expression is not a verdict, but I recommend remaining concerned.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Your other secret

Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner what makes a story worth publishing when a donor objects.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux whether he reads the anonymous museum newsletter. Do not admit you write it.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Televised drama is a distraction. Our drama hides at its back.*
- 2 *The household monument to victory is standing on a secret.*
- 3 *A scarlet stage has a backstage secret. Check behind its fabric.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous newsletter is mine. Some jokes came from private conversations, and one hurt somebody who didn't deserve it. Grant planned to expose the author tonight. I was prepared to admit the newsletter. I was considerably less prepared to let him introduce it as a tribute to himself.

IF MURDERER

I wrote the newsletter and used private conversations I should have protected. Grant would unmask me at the gala and have my professional invitations withdrawn. He demanded favorable coverage in exchange. A man unable to recognize satire had finally discovered its author and wished to become its editor.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.

IF MURDERER

I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous column was mine, as was the paid correction. The printer still has the earlier edition and the invoice for the later one. Grant wanted the smaller correction expanded into a tribute. I left the version the printer had already set. Neither edition accuses him of poisoning anyone; both show what I was willing to sell.

IF MURDERER

The anonymous column and the paid correction were mine. Grant wanted a tribute in place of the correction. I left him the smaller paragraph because the tribute would make the payment obvious to every reader. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my newsletter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before leaving him the smaller correction.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACCUSATIONS



Drew Conclusions

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The column was mine, the correction was paid, and the phone edit concealed that payment. The printer kept the editions and invoice. I did not murder Grant. I will put my name and the transaction beside the correction. Readers can decide how funny they find the original after learning what its author sold.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my newsletter folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted the satire turned into his tribute. I killed him rather than admit what I had sold him.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Brie DeVivre

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Brie DeVivre

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director

Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts.

- Goes over catering costs with **Monet Bags**. Brie keeps the receipts. He knows **Monet** is addicted to expensive cheddar.
- **Barb Dwyer** keeps revising the service routes. Brie wants the staff to have one usable plan. Brie knows **Barb** is lactose intolerant.
- **Artie Ficial** calls on Brie to keep donors fed while the museum deals with a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side. You also know everyone's secrets!

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Brie DeVivre. I am responsible for dinner. If you enjoy it, remember my name. If you do not, blame the donor's instructions.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Your other secret

You substituted a cheaper dessert supplier without correcting the menu, changed the private setup on contradictory instructions, and withheld the unpaid extra course. The kitchen retained that order.

Conversations to start

- Ask Monet Bags whether Grant has approved the catering invoice.
- Ask Barb Dwyer which service routes are open for tonight's gala.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The life of Bonhoeffer contains more than its author intended.*
- 2 *Find a flower's borrowed home and inspect its hollow heart.*
- 3 *A shade the color of leaves marks the place to search beside a lamp.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Brie DeVivre

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Brie DeVivre

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant refused my invoice, then ordered a new private service. He and his assistant gave opposite instructions. I changed the setup twice and billed the changes. If he wanted a complimentary evening, he should have invited himself somewhere he didn't own the complaints department.

IF MURDERER

Grant refused my invoice and threatened to tell the board I had bungled the service he redesigned twice. I kept the change orders. He called them excuses. I told him a chef can absorb a criticism. Absorbing payroll is considerably harder. He laughed at my staff's wages.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Brie DeVivre

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Brie DeVivre

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I withheld Grant's unpaid extra course and used a cheaper supplier than the menu promised. While the manager was in the kitchen, I went to the private table for the invoice. Sauce had spilled across it and onto the glass base. I moved the glass and rescued the paper. The course stayed in the kitchen. He wanted more service while disputing what he had already ordered. I wanted the charges acknowledged before serving it.

IF MURDERER

I withheld Grant's unpaid extra course and used a cheaper supplier than the menu promised. While the manager was in the kitchen, I went to the private table for the invoice. Sauce had spilled across it and onto the glass base. I moved the glass and rescued the paper. The course stayed in the kitchen. He wanted more service while disputing what he had already ordered. I wanted the charges acknowledged before serving it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Brie DeVivre

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Brie DeVivre

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I moved the glass by its stem and wiped sauce from the base before rescuing the invoice. The kitchen retained my order holding back the extra course. Food and shared punch tested clear. The red wrapper in my service folder came from the dessert box; it has the supplier's printing on the back. I concealed that cheaper supplier. I also refused to serve Grant's private course without payment. Those were the disputes on my invoice.

IF MURDERER

My bill grew because Grant kept changing his mind. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my invoice folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while laying down the private invoice.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Brie DeVivre

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed the supplier substitution, changed the setup on contradictory instructions and withheld the unpaid course. The kitchen's order and the clear food and punch results survive. I wiped sauce from the glass's base, not poison into it. I will disclose the supplier and give the estate the actual invoice. The disputed course was never served.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my invoice folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He demanded more private service while disputing every charge. I poisoned one glass and left the shared food and punch clear.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Your other secret

You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Conversations to start

- Ask Chip Patina whether the minor frame damage can be repaired after the gala.
- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which installation needs your attention before the unveiling.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*
- 2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*
- 3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. That would leave my name on an account neither of us believed. I was angry with him and with myself for making the omission he expected me to sign.

IF MURDERER

I concealed a repairable frame crack with a reversible mount. I should have reported it. Grant wanted an undamaged delivery record for the photographs, even after he had seen the crack. He was satisfied as long as the damage stayed out of sight. I would still be the handler whose name was on the record when it was found.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.

IF MURDERER

I delivered the boxed donor glass from the shop to the service manager, then went back to the damaged frame. I had hidden its crack with the packing blanket. The freight lift failed while I was moving the trolley, and I stayed with the work until the mechanic released it. Grant wanted the delivery recorded as undamaged. I had already failed to report the crack; I was being asked to turn that omission into a signed condition report.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The shop's delivery slip identifies the boxed donor glass handed to the service manager. The frame's repair estimate and the mechanic's lift record concern a different object. I had concealed the crack before the lift fault. The estimate records that damage, including when I first saw it. I should have filed it instead of hoping a reversible mount would turn it into somebody else's discovery.

IF MURDERER

I had delivered the boxed donor glass to the service manager. Later, when I brought the trolley through the salon, the glass was unwrapped near the edge of Grant's table. I moved it farther in before taking the trolley past. I was still wearing the work gloves I had used on the preparation walkthrough. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught inside one glove's cuff. The repair estimate concerns the frame crack I concealed. Grant wanted the photographs to show an undamaged delivery; the blanket did not make the damage disappear.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Cary Crates

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed the frame crack before the lift fault. The shop's glass delivery and the mechanic's record concern different objects; the repair estimate records the damage I hid. I did not kill Grant. I will report the crack with the actual date I saw it. A careful delivery afterward does not make the earlier omission disappear.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. Moving it out of the trolley's path gave me an ordinary reason to handle it. A fragment of the bottle's custody band caught inside my work-glove cuff; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and I had admitted wearing those gloves at both places. He ordered the frame damage concealed and threatened to blame me. I killed him instead of reporting the crack.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.
- Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.
- Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Anne E. Dote

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Your other secret

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she will defend the education program against a donor lounge.
- Ask Claire O'Scuro what ordinary visitors would lose if education funding disappeared.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*
- 2 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*
- 3 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I circulated the petition without authorization. Grant's gift replaced the education space with a private donor lounge. The staff whose jobs would disappear had not been consulted. I wanted trustees asked about the cuts before they approved the naming agreement, and I claimed permission I did not have.

IF MURDERER

I circulated the petition without authorization. Grant's gift replaced the education space with a private donor lounge. The staff whose jobs would disappear had not been consulted. I wanted trustees asked about the cuts before they approved the naming agreement. I was not prepared to let him buy that approval quietly.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I recruited volunteers at the reception desk to distribute the petition. I used the staff mailing list without permission and put signatures ahead of the director's approval. Grant's proposal replaced the education space with a donor lounge. I wanted trustees asked about that before the naming announcement. I told a volunteer the director supported us. I had not asked him. The petition was real; the authorization I claimed was not.

IF MURDERER

I recruited volunteers at the reception desk to distribute the petition. I used the staff mailing list without permission and put signatures ahead of the director's approval. Grant's proposal replaced the education space with a donor lounge. I wanted trustees asked about that before the naming announcement. I told a volunteer the director supported us. I had not asked him. The petition was real; the authorization I claimed was not.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The education staff retained the petition and my request to use the mailing list. I sent it before receiving permission. The replies and signatures identify exactly what I circulated. Grant called it a campaign against his gift. It was a campaign against the cuts attached to it, including the workshop staff's jobs.

IF MURDERER

I used the staff mailing list without permission. Grant wanted the petition withdrawn before the gift announcement. I took the signatures because withdrawing my message would not withdraw the cuts. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my petition clipboard. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while showing him the education signatures.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Anne E. Dote

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I used the staff list and claimed the director's permission without asking. The petition signatures are real. I did not poison Grant. I will account for the unauthorized mailing and tell the volunteers which approval I invented. Then I will ask the trustees what happens to the education space now that the gift is disputed.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my petition clipboard when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He was cutting the programs and buying a workshop bearing his name. I killed him before the donors heard his version of generosity.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Faye Stop

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Faye Stop

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist

Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for **Paige Turner**.
- **Dada DiCapo** loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Faye Stop. I am your photographer. Give me your good side, then try not to confess anything while I have the camera up.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Faye Stop

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Your other secret

You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner whether a photograph can be newsworthy without its owner's permission.
- Ask Hugh Bidder why a donor might object to being photographed beside a shipping file.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A silent encore waits under the instrument with black and white keys.*
- 2 *The route to this discovery runs through a map of the Catalan capital.*
- 3 *Something has slipped behind the soft blue square on the seat.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. I was unwilling to hand over the print, although keeping it meant breaking my word.

IF MURDERER

I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. Once I had seen the papers in that picture, I could not accept his deciding whether it survived.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.

IF MURDERER

I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The separate print predates my promise to delete the camera image. The lab kept the print order, and the image includes the shipping papers beside Grant's meeting. I concealed a copy from him; I did not fabricate what it shows. The original print order accounts for the photograph he thought I had made disappear.

IF MURDERER

I promised Grant that the camera file was gone and retained the separate print. He wanted every copy destroyed. The shipping papers in the image were the reason I would not do that. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my print sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying the retained photograph beside him.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Faye Stop

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I retained the print and let Grant believe deleting the file had destroyed every copy. The original print order survives. I did not kill him. I will supply the photograph with its actual date and explain the selective answer I gave. The shipping papers in that image deserve investigation without another deletion.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my print sleeve when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted the retained photograph destroyed. I killed him to preserve evidence of a different crime.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Robin Banks

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates **Dr. Art E. Fact** and **Mona Lott** on strategy.
- **Barb Dwyer** has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- **Anne E. Dote** quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Robin Banks. I campaign for restitution. A disputed object does not become less disputed when somebody puts flowers beside it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Robin Banks

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Your other secret

You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Conversations to start

- Ask Mona Lott what the museum owes people represented in its collection.
- Ask Barb Dwyer what protest would get you removed from tonight's event.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A trophy is more than decoration tonight. Check below its foot.*
- 2 *Where red drapes close the scene, evidence waits out of sight.*
- 3 *A secret has been put on ice, quite literally.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The stickers were mine. PROVENANCE IS A VERB fits nicely in a brochure that treats ownership as a permanent noun. Grant had me removed from an earlier event and threatened legal action tonight. I came to make the collection's history visible. He wanted me visible only on a security notice.

IF MURDERER

I planted the stickers because another polite letter had accomplished nothing. Grant threatened to have me removed again before the unveiling. He would announce permanent ownership while the people asking questions waited outside. A gala was becoming another ceremony of possession.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.

IF MURDERER

I put a protest sticker on Grant's jacket during the reception photograph. He tore it off and had security move me away from the display. I returned to distribute the brochures anyway. I had promised to stay out of the public presentation and broken that promise. Grant threatened legal action. I wanted the ownership dispute visible in the photographs he would use to celebrate permanent possession of the collection.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Robin Banks

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Robin Banks

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The brochure's printer kept my artwork and the order for the protest stickers. The disputed object and its claimant are named on the back. I distributed the brochures before Grant demanded his copy destroyed. Those surviving copies explain the argument and establish which questions I brought to the museum.

IF MURDERER

Grant tore the sticker off his jacket. I wanted the protest in the toast photograph anyway. I picked up his empty glass in the salon, pressed another sticker onto its base and set it back at his place. I still had the brochures under my arm; other guests had already taken copies. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my brochure. I had that brochure with me on the preparation walkthrough and when I handled the glass. I had promised not to interfere with the presentation. I broke that promise again.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Robin Banks

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Robin Banks

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I put the sticker on his jacket and returned after promising to stay out of the presentation. The printer kept the brochure artwork. I did not poison him. I will answer for breaking that promise and give the claimant the files. Grant's death does not turn disputed possession into permanent ownership.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. The sticker was my excuse for picking it up. A fragment of the bottle's custody band caught in my brochure; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and my account placed me at both objects. He wanted me removed before announcing permanent ownership. I murdered him in the museum whose history I wanted corrected.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Asks **Hugh Bidder** for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.
- Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.
- Has compared auction finds with **Tess Tament**. Penny prefers a bargain **Tess** has overlooked.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Penny Pincher

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Your other secret

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she remembers the decorative object from your family.
- Ask Saul D. Bid how old private sales can be traced. If he is absent, try Hugh Bidder.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1** *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*
- 2** *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*
- 3** *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I was asking the museum to tell a history I had not told honestly myself.

IF MURDERER

The family letters challenge Grant's account of the sale. I brought them intending to confront him and left out the letter implicating my grandfather. Grant knew the missing part and offered to buy our silence. I would not accept his price or let him announce his version unchallenged.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Penny Pincher

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I burned the photocopy of Grant's offer on the smoking terrace. It named a price for my family's silence. I had withheld the letter that explained my grandfather's part in the sale and did not want another guest reading the offer. The originals remained in my case. Grant watched me destroy the copy and said there were others. I believed him. I had come demanding justice and was concealing the part that made my family harder to defend.

IF MURDERER

I burned the photocopy of Grant's offer on the smoking terrace. It named a price for my family's silence. I had withheld the letter that explained my grandfather's part in the sale and did not want another guest reading the offer. The originals remained in my case. Grant watched me destroy the copy and said there were others. I believed him. I had come demanding justice and was concealing the part that made my family harder to defend.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The letter I withheld identifies my grandfather's part in the sale. The family solicitor retained its transcript before tonight. Grant's offer to buy our silence is written beside that transcript. I wanted a cleaner family history; the letter will not give me one. Both papers can be examined without taking my version on trust.

IF MURDERER

I omitted the letter about my grandfather from the family display. Grant knew what it said and offered to buy our silence. I had come to argue over the sale instead of accepting his price. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my family-letter case. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to make him look at the disputed sale date.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Penny Pincher

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I burned the copy of his offer and withheld the letter implicating my grandfather. The family solicitor retained its transcript. I did not kill Grant. I will release the letter and stop presenting a family history with the difficult page removed. His offer to buy our silence will accompany it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my family-letter case when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He offered to buy the family's silence. I killed him rather than reveal what my grandfather's letter admitted.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Justin Tyme

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Justin Tyme

Independent Blogger & Local Truthstorian

Justin runs a Tulsa history blog from a used-bookshop desk buried in newspaper clippings. He tracks old property deeds, vanished music venues, and the names donors would rather leave off the plaque. Ask him about a grand local family and he may reach for a folder instead of a compliment.

- **Paige Turner** considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.
- Gives local-history talks for **Anne E. Dote**. She keeps asking him to finish before the museum closes.
- Has been digging into the museum's early property records. **Artie Ficial** keeps offering him the official anniversary brochure.

ACTING TIPS

Sociable, stubborn, and easily sidetracked by a good lead. Ask who owned the building before the museum arrived. Treat an old clipping like something worth showing the person beside you.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Justin Tyme. I run a local history blog. If your family funded this wing, I'd love to hear about it. I brought the property records.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Justin Tyme

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Your other secret

You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner how she corrects a flattering story when its subject objects.
- Ask Artie Ficial how much influence Grant expects over the museum's public image.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Justin Tyme

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A biography about costly courage conceals a small piece of tonight's puzzle.*
- 2 *Look inside a cupboard: the evidence has chosen a room with its own door.*
- 3 *Above the garage door, a document waits for a safe pair of hands.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Justin Tyme

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Justin Tyme

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I owe Tulsa a correction. Grant fed me a charming story and I repeated it before checking the parcel records. He wanted the error preserved as local history. I've seen too many confident men turn a convenient story into a plaque. I was about to remove his plaque, figuratively speaking.

IF MURDERER

My correction would expose Grant and embarrass me. I could live with that. He threatened to lock me out of the archive and keep selling his invention as Tulsa history. People love a tidy origin story. This one had a deed attached, and the deed disagreed with him.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Justin Tyme

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Justin Tyme

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I recorded a walking account of the property deal in the gallery, then stopped when a guest asked about the actual boundary. I knew the parcel record contradicted the version I was telling. Grant had promised archive access if I left his story alone. I deleted the take from the public feed and kept it on the recorder. Tulsa did not need another confident version of the wrong deed. I had supplied one anyway.

IF MURDERER

I recorded a walking account of the property deal in the gallery, then stopped when a guest asked about the actual boundary. I knew the parcel record contradicted the version I was telling. Grant had promised archive access if I left his story alone. I deleted the take from the public feed and kept it on the recorder. Tulsa did not need another confident version of the wrong deed. I had supplied one anyway.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Justin Tyme

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Justin Tyme

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The county parcel record contradicts the story I printed. The recorder's index and my draft correction identify the same boundary. Grant's note promised access to a family archive if I kept the old story going. I retained that note. It explains why I delayed correcting a story I had enjoyed telling.

IF MURDERER

I let Grant's parcel story stand after finding the boundary record. He was threatening my access to the family archive. I took the map away because I did not want him dictating what my correction would say. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my parcel-map folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass while opening the parcel print.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Justin Tyme

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Justin Tyme

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I kept telling the wrong parcel story after finding the boundary record. I deleted the public take and concealed the archive offer. I did not murder Grant. I will publish the correction and the offer under my own name. Tulsa has quite enough stories that acquired authority because somebody enjoyed telling them.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my parcel-map folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He threatened my access to the archive and kept selling his parcel story. I murdered him instead of letting the deed answer him.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Minnie Malist

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Minnie Malist

Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer

Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp.

- Works constantly with **Frank Lloyd Wrong**, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- **Brie DeVivre** is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- **Monet Bags** is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Minnie Malist. I produce the events. A successful gala is one in which nobody notices how close it came to collapsing.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Minnie Malist

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Your other secret

You removed the donor lettering and hid an unauthorized blackout inside the naming sequence. The safety override stopped that sequence; later flickers came from the electrician's test. You do not want the canceled intentional interruption mistaken for an approved cue.

Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which lighting cue he objected to.
- Ask Monet Bags whether the gala budget includes Grant's last-minute changes.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The hard metal seat has an understudy: a clue waiting underneath.*
- 2 *A picture may be worth a thousand words. There are more words behind this one.*
- 3 *The clue is inside the book whose final chapter is Revelation.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Minnie Malist

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Minnie Malist

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed the approved lighting cue. Grant restored the donor lettering and threatened payment when I objected. I then prepared a blackout he had not authorized. It was intended to interrupt the naming announcement. The operator did not know what I had hidden in that sequence.

IF MURDERER

I changed the approved lighting cue. Grant restored the donor lettering and threatened payment when I objected. I then prepared a blackout he had not authorized. It was intended to interrupt the naming announcement. I wanted his words cut off in front of the people financing them.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Minnie Malist

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Minnie Malist

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I prepared a blackout for the naming announcement after Grant restored the donor lettering I had removed. I hid that cue inside the reduced lighting sequence. The performance team also had red metallic paper from the shared supplies for its closing effect. Then the real mounting alert forced the safety override. The electrician stopped the revised sequence. I had planned to interrupt Grant in front of the donors; I had not asked the operator to announce that plan.

IF MURDERER

I prepared a blackout for the naming announcement after Grant restored the donor lettering I had removed. I hid that cue inside the reduced lighting sequence. The performance team also had red metallic paper from the shared supplies for its closing effect. Then the real mounting alert forced the safety override. The electrician stopped the revised sequence. I had planned to interrupt Grant in front of the donors; I had not asked the operator to announce that plan.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Minnie Malist

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Minnie Malist

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The console log records the safety override before my reduced sequence was tested. The electrician retained my revised cue sheet. The change I made removed the donor lettering and cut the load; it did not disable the museum security system. I wanted Grant's name off the wall, and I had changed the program without permission. The later flickers came from the electrician's test; the intended blackout never ran. Barb's camera work was on a separate system. The inventory also lists red foil-backed confetti offcuts in my cue folder. The electrician and manager retained the unused effect materials.

IF MURDERER

The override stopped my hidden blackout. I then reset Grant's place for the donor photograph, turning his empty glass clear of the centerpiece. My cue-sheet folder stayed under my arm. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in that folder; I carried it on the preparation walkthrough too. I was still being paid to make his evening look immaculate.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Minnie Malist

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I hid an unauthorized blackout in the naming sequence. The safety override stopped it; the later flickers came from the electrician's test. The unused confetti and revised cue sheet survive. I did not poison Grant. I will deliver the actual job log, including the cue I intended to run, instead of passing the whole interruption off as a safety fault.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. Resetting the place for its photograph gave me a reason to handle it. A fragment of the bottle's custody band caught in my cue-sheet folder; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and my account placed the folder at both locations. The safety override stopped the blackout I had hidden. It did not stop me. He wanted his name restored and threatened my payment. I made a dispute about the program end in murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.